rhythm. A codetta leads to a cadence in G minor, closing the first section of the fugue.

Middle and Final Sections.—These are not clearly differentiated, as there is scarcely any modulation away from the two principal keys. It would be possible to regard either the first entry of the bass (bar 19) or the beginning of the second stretto (bar 23) as marking the commencement of a "final section"; but the latter is more in the character of a coda.

The first stretto commences at bar 14, the subject in the treble being immediately imitated in the alto by augmentation, and in the next bar answered by inverse movement in the tenor. From the 16th bar the subject and answer appear at distances of half a bar in the three upper parts, and at bar 19 the fourth voice (the bass) makes its appearance with fine effect, giving the subject by augmentation. The inverted and the original forms of the answer follow immediately in the same voice, bars 21 to 23. In bar 23 begins the second, and closer stretto. Here the alto and treble take the subject and answer at one crotchet's distance, and again—reversing their order of entry—successive appearances of the subject, commencing respectively on tonic and dominant; two beats later the tenor introduces the subject, and two beats later again the bass brings it in, inverted and somewhat modified.

The entire fugue is one of the most perfect in the series.

FUGUE 27 (Book II, 3)

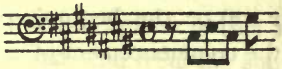
C SHARP MAJOR (THREE VOICES).

A very troublesome fugue to analyse, owing to the difficulty in determining where the subject terminates. An examination of

Ebenezer Prout: Analysis of J. S. Bach's Forty-Eight Fugues
Ed. Louis B. Prout. London: Edwin Ashdown, 1910. Printed pp. 55-57.
BWV 872. Complete original pages; adjoining commentary is retained.
Full source scan

the latter part of the fugue shows that it should be regarded as consisting of only the first four notes. This is consequently the shortest subject to be found in the forty-eight.

Exposition.—The subject is given out in the bass:—



The answer, in the treble, is **tonal**; there is no regular counter-subject, or at least not beyond the exposition. In the third voice, the alto, the subject is given by inverse movement, a somewhat unusal treatment for the exposition.

Counter-Exposition.—A counter-exposition occupies bar 4 and the first half of bar 5, and to this succeeds immediately the middle section.

Middle Section.—First the answer is given in the treble and alto by diminution (bar 5), and in the bass by diminution and inversion; then the answer in all three voices in notes of the original length, the bass leading, and with continuation in canonic imitation; next follow two stretti (bars 9 to 10 and 10 to 12), the former entirely in inverse movement, the latter first inverted (bass, treble) and then direct (alto, bass).

There are two episodes. The first (bars 12 to 14) is founded on a variation of the subject treated sequentially in the bass. The second (bars 20 to 24) is somewhat similar in character, the bass of bar 12, in a modified form, being treated by diminution in the treble of bar 20.

A second stretto appears in bars 14 to 16, the answer direct being alternated with the subject inverted. An isolated entry in

the bass of bar 17 is succeded by three in diminution, the alto and the bass inverted, then the bass direct. After Episode 2, another isolated entry in the bass (bar 24, answer) leads to the final section.

Final Section.—This introduces the last stretto (bars 25, 26) in which the subject in the treble, inverse movement, is answered in the alto by augmentation and in the bass in the original form, though beginning on the submediant. The remaining entries, in bars 27, 28 to 29, 30 to 31, 31 to 32, present no specially new features, and need not be discussed in detail. The coda, from bar 32 to the end, contains one or two reminiscences of the subject by diminution; as is often the case with Bach, it introduces additional voices.

FUGUE 28 (Book II, 4)

C SHARP MINOR (THREE VOICES)

Exposition.—The subject is announced in the bass:—



The answer, in the treble, is **real**, and reaches to the first semiquaver of bar 4; the rest of that bar forms a codetta, sequentially copying the close of the subject, and modulating back preparatory to the entry of the subject in the alto in bar 5.

Counter-Exposition.—There is a partial or irregular counter-exposition from bar 16, only two voices (treble and alto) conforming to the rule of tonality, while the remaining voice enters (at bar 20) in the key of the relative major.*

*Riemann (Katechismus der Fuge-n-Komposition, ii., p. 32, treats this group as part of the middle (modulatory) section. [ED.]